

JOB SEARCH PLANNING AND PREPARATION

Advertised job positions may receive 50—200+ applications, so a skilled approach is necessary.

- Carefully target your CV and cover letter to the requirements stated in the advertisement.
- Match what you have to offer with the requirement of the position
- Consider what the employer might need to know about you for that position
- Research more about the role and organisation – ask for a job description
- It is easy to match what you have to offer with what the employer is looking for by simply using the advert as prompts for writing your cover letter and your CV. Highlight the qualifications, qualities, experience, and skills that they are asking for (see resource sheet **Guide to CV writing**)
- And don't forget to make sure your online presence is up to date, particularly your LinkedIn profile (see our career resource sheet on **Use of LinkedIn**)
- After applying, follow up with a phone call if you don't hear back from them within a week

ADDITIONAL TIPS

Emailing the same CV to every possible employer **DOES NOT WORK**. CVs must be targeted and a personal introduction made.

Prepare information about yourself

- Be clear about the skills and abilities you want to emphasise as your most marketable qualities and greatest assets
- Communicate how you will contribute and add value to your target organisation
- Be well organised and efficient in your communications

Research your targets

- Identify specific employers e.g. through internet, word of mouth and industry publications.
- Visit the websites of organisations you think you would like to work for and find out about them
- Know the environment and conditions of employment that you are seeking in a job
- Check out the culture of the organisation to make sure that you fit
- Most jobs exist within small organisations, so don't restrict your job search to large ones

Practice to improve your impact

- Practise your interview and presentation skills (see Career Resource **Interviews** sheets)
- Be really well prepared before you dial the number and know what you want to achieve before you finish.

Plan your approach

- Ask your networking contacts for referrals
- Prepare targeted information for each contact
- If writing or emailing, direct it to a particular person
- Follow up with a phone call, asking for a short meeting rather than an interview
- Keep a list of everyone you approach, including the organization, person and title, as well as the date
- Always have your targeted CV and letter of introduction ready to present

SOCIAL MEDIA IS AN IMPORTANT JOB SEARCH TOOL

Social media is increasingly important as a job search tool – and not just LinkedIn. Follow companies on Instagram, Twitter and FaceBook. Many companies only advertise now on those mediums. See our career resource on **Social media job search** for further ideas.